

Client:

Nadia Myre

Associate Professor, Department of Studio Arts

Canada Research Chair, Indigenous Arts Practice

Director, Kinawind Lab

A Song for My Mother: Materializing Voice

The larger project, titled *A Song for My Mother*, is a research-creation project which examines the intergenerational effects of forced adoption and institutionalized family separation in Canada. The project will culminate in a large-scale tapestry woven from ceramic beads, in which I am exploring ways for survivor voices—stories, reflections, fragments of speech, and most probably song—to become materially embedded within the work, so that the tapestry might, in some way, “sing.”

I am curious about **how sound might become materially encoded in, carried by, or activated through ceramic**. And would love to invite teams to develop speculative and functional prototypes for translating recorded voice into a physical/material form and creating an interaction through which that voice can be recovered, activated, heard, or otherwise experienced through ceramic. As an artist, I am especially interested in the space between a functional design solution and an artwork. The goal is not necessarily perfect audio reproduction. A voice might become vibration, colour, pattern, texture, resonance, fragments of sound—or something I have not anticipated. Distortion, loss, and partial legibility could be as meaningful as technical success, particularly within a project concerned with memory, absence, fragmented histories, and structural “not-knowing.”

In other words, the challenge is not simply “**How can a ceramic object play a recording?**” but “**What might it mean for ceramic to remember a voice?**”

The Envisaged final form might have students develop a series of physical proof-of-concept prototypes combining ceramics with computation, sound, electronics, sensors, mechanical systems, 3D printing, or other approaches they wish to explore... I am pretty open to what form this might take.

- physical computing / interactive objects
- custom software for translating physical or visual data into audio (most keen)
- experimental sound playback or scanning devices (most keen)
- electronics and sensor-based systems
- 3D-printed test objects or ceramic forms
- mechanical or analog playback systems
- hybrid digital/physical installations